

THE SAME HOUSE TWICE

THE SPINE, v1.1

Supersedes v1.0. Reworked 2026-08-27 against ChatGPT's step-3 audit (verdict REWORK, premise survives). **All seven findings accepted. None is contested.** Three Stephen rulings were taken during the rework and are in Part J.

The opening determination is accepted and kept: a murder that has not happened yet is an asset, not a fatal flaw. What was wrong was never the missing body. It was the clock, the antagonist's trap and the access logic.

What changed, and why it is one move rather than four patches

#	Finding	Repair
1	The flat sale does not trap Colin, it funds his escape	★ The attempt has already started. Winnie is being poisoned when the episode opens. Stopping no longer saves him, because a blood level taken this week proves it. The trap is evidential, not financial, and it is already true
2	Yardley is claimed as both an open route and a closed one	★ He talks on day three, freely, and it achieves nothing. A doctor's retrospective doubt is not evidence and Del cannot act on it. What he can do is clinical, not testimonial
3	Day 18 is neither lawfully available nor causally connected	★ Deleted. The clock is now Winnie's decline, day-stamped by the last care visit Colin has already cancelled. It changes his capability because it removes the only observer
4	Agency arithmetic passes, substance fails	All four decisions rebuilt. The false trades are gone
5	Josie's safeguarding route is missing	She discharged it two months ago. It was filed. Nothing happened. Ruling question 6
6	Part B clears neither the clinical nor the pharmacy safeguard	★ The claim that nobody was wrong is withdrawn. Yardley was wrong, and Part A2 now says why. Pharmacy answered by ruling
7	The certification chain may contain an unasked reviewer	★ Ruled in, and it became the best decision in the episode. See Part J1

Findings 1, 2 and 3 dissolve into a single change. That is the test this rework had to pass: one true change fixing three defects, rather than four props holding up four holes.

One correction to the audit, accepted everywhere else. It says the green-lamps detail strengthens the toxicity picture against Yardley. It does not: Edith said it to Marion on the telephone and Yardley never heard it. The detail is evidence for the audience and for Marion. Finding 6 still stands on nausea and confusion alone, and is answered by conceding rather than defending.

O. THE CARE LINE

Episode. An eighty-one-year-old woman is already being poisoned by the man who does her shopping, and she is the only person who can authorise the test that would prove it. Nobody can make her, and she is not wrong to refuse. In eleven days the last person who sees her from outside that house stops coming.

Phase One, leads 1 to 6. Someone says a woman is being killed and will not put it in writing. Nobody knows whether she is a crank or the only person who has been paying attention. Two people died in that house before.

Phase Two, leads 7 to 11. The doctor tells the truth on the first afternoon and it turns out to be worth nothing. Nobody knows how to prove a thing about a living woman without her permission. Getting it costs her something she will not give up.

Phase Three, leads 12 to 16. The man does not know the rules changed and that he will be caught after she dies. Nobody knows whether telling him is mercy or surrender. Telling him saves her and closes the other two forever.

PART A. WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Years counted back from the game's now. The house is **14 Orchard Steps, Highcliff Heights.**

A1. The first one, Year –16

When	What
Y–22	Colin Meade, then 32, marries Ruth Yardley . Her brother is Dr Alan Yardley , then 49, a GP at the Highcliff practice. Colin is the doctor's brother-in-law from this day, and that is the whole mechanism
Y–19	Colin, a gardener, starts doing the garden for Edith Larkin , 76, widow, heart failure, on digoxin ★ Edith was a court stenographer for thirty-one years and could still read a conversation back to you word for word. It is why the one thing she said about her own symptoms was said precisely, and why it survived sixteen years in her daughter's memory
Y–19 to Y–16	Two and a half years. Garden, then shopping, then the boxes she cannot read. He is not pretending. He is genuinely good at it
Y–17, Mar	Edith changes her will at a solicitor's, alone and competent. The house to Colin
Y–16, Jan	Colin moves into the annexe
Y–16, Feb	Over about ten days he raises her dose. Nausea, unsteadiness, confusion. She tells her daughter Marion on the telephone that the lamps have gone green. Marion thinks it is a strange thing to say
Y–16, Feb	Yardley visits twice. He sees a woman with heart failure who is deteriorating, which is what he expects. He does not order a blood level. See A2: this is a real failure and the episode says so
Y–16, 7 Mar	Edith dies in the night. Yardley certifies heart failure. He attended her last illness, so he may certify, and there is no referral and at that date no independent review
Y–16	Cremation, per her wishes. Probate. The house passes to Colin. He sells it fourteen months later

A2. Ruth, and why Yardley stopped being able to think

When	What
Y-9	Ruth is diagnosed. Colin nurses her at home for eleven months and does it better than her brother the doctor can
Y-9, and it lasts about a week	★ Yardley lets himself wonder whether Colin is helping her along. He looks. He is wrong: the disease is doing exactly what the disease does, and there is nothing to find
★ Y-9 onward	He never forgives himself for having thought it. He had suspected the man who sat up with his sister every night for eleven months, on nothing. That week is why he could not think it again about Edith and could not think it about Gordon. His blindness has a cause and the cause is decency turned inside out
Y-9	Ruth dies of cancer. She is not a victim and the episode establishes that plainly. The wound is that he suspected, not that he missed

A3. The second one, Year –5

When	What
Y–7	Gordon Pace , 74, buys 14 Orchard Steps. Widower, no children, one nephew he has not spoken to in twenty years. Atrial fibrillation, on digoxin. Yardley's patient, because Yardley has that street
	★ Gordon kept homing pigeons for forty years and gave them up at seventy-four because he could not manage the ladder to the loft. Colin offered to climb it for him. That is how Colin got in, and it is also a life rather than an illness
Y–6	The Edith money is gone. Colin takes handyman work back on Orchard Steps, the only street where he already has a character reference
Y–5, May	Gordon changes his will. The house to Colin
Y–5, Aug	★ The pharmacy query, and it is answered correctly. Colin collects a repeat early. The pharmacist queries it. He says a box went down the sink. That happens constantly. She records the reason and supplies, exactly as she should. A dated, accurate, competent note that nobody has ever read since
Y–5, 12 Oct	Gordon dies at home. Same drug, same presentation, same doctor
Y–5, 12 Oct	★ Yardley signs, and this is the difference between the two deaths: this time he knows and will not look. He goes home and does not sleep, and has not really slept since
Y–5	Burial, Havenbay. Not cremated. Colin is executor, so Colin holds the paperwork
Y–4	Probate. The house passes to Colin a second time and the public register records it
Y–3	Colin sells the house to Winnie Aspinall , 78
★ Y–3	★ Havenbay introduces independent review of every non-coronial death certificate. A medical examiner checks the stated cause and may contact a representative. Edith and Gordon both predate it. Colin does not know it exists

A4. Now

When	What
Y-3 to now	Colin does Winnie's garden, then her shopping, then, this year, her medicines. Atrial fibrillation, on digoxin. Yardley is her GP
	Winnie made her own money and bought into Highcliff late, so she has a street full of neighbours who have never once knocked. The only person on Orchard Steps who is kind to her is the man who sold her the house
4 months ago	She changes her will, alone, entirely competent. A second cousin she has met twice, or the man who comes every day. She is not tricked, not groomed, and not confused. She is right to feel what she feels, and it is what kills her
~10 weeks ago	Colin's money runs out again. He puts his flat on the market. △ This explains why now. It is not a trap and nothing structural rests on it
~8 weeks ago	Josie Renn , 46, of Highcliff Home Care, twice a week. She was Gordon's carer five years ago on the same street for the same agency. She recognises Colin
~7 weeks ago	★ Josie reports it to her provider. Formally, in writing, as her code of conduct requires. The provider records it, tells her not to discuss it with anyone including the client, and does nothing else , because an unevidenced allegation by a staff member against a devoted family carer is exactly the kind of thing that gets filed. A third complete, accurate, dated record that nobody has read
~3 weeks ago	★ Colin starts raising Winnie's dose. He does not wait for anything. He has never waited
~2 weeks ago	Winnie is nauseated, tired and unsteady on her feet. She is eighty-one and she has a heart condition, and she is furious with everyone who mentions it
9 days ago	★ Colin tells the agency Winnie no longer needs the visits. He is entitled to relay that and Winnie, asked, confirms it, because she does not want a carer
Day 1	The cancellation reaches the rota Josie reads. She telephones the show, gives her name, and refuses to be recorded or to put anything in writing , because she has already been told once not to discuss it. Ally has notes
★ Day 12	The last scheduled care visit. After that, nobody outside that house sees Winnie Aspinall

What he is. Not a compulsive killer and not proud of a method. **He does this when the money runs out**, twice in sixteen years, and he chooses people whose absence nobody will argue about. **He is kind to them**,

genuinely, for a year or two first. That is not the disguise. That is the method.

★ He is not hiding. Every step is correctly recorded on a permanent public register and has been for years. Nobody read two lines of it next to each other.

PART B. WHY NOBODY NOTICED

★ The v1.0 claim that nobody was wrong is **WITHDRAWN**. It was inherited from a different premise where it was load-bearing. Here it is false and unnecessary. **Somebody was wrong, and the episode names him.**

Question	Answer
Two deaths, one address, same doctor, same beneficiary. No flag?	Nothing cross-references deaths by property. A certificate is indexed to a person, carries no beneficiary field, and probate is a different office in a different year
★ Should Yardley have suspected toxicity in Edith?	★ Yes. He should have ordered a level and he did not. Nausea, unsteadiness and confusion in an elderly patient on this drug is a recognised picture. He is not exonerated and the episode does not try. He never heard the visual symptom, which is the only part of the picture he genuinely lacked, and A2 gives the reason he could not let himself think it. He is believable, not blameless
And in Gordon?	★ He knew. That is the whole of his character
The pharmacy?	★ A pharmacist queried an early repeat and was given an ordinary true-sounding reason, which she recorded and supplied against. Correct practice, dated note, never read again. Ruled, Part J2
The certificates?	No independent review existed at either date. Ruled, Part J1
Josie?	★ She reported it. Her provider filed it. Ruled, Part J3
The neighbours?	Highcliff. Gated terraces, private security, and eleven years

★ The thesis, and it is the show's: the record is not wrong. **It is complete, accurate, public and permanent, in four separate institutions, and nobody ever read any two lines of it next to each other.**

PART C. THE ACCESS LEDGER

★ Co. NOTHING IS THE ONLY ROUTE, AND THIS TIME IT IS TRUE

v1.0 claimed this and then quietly closed Yardley for seven leads to make the plot work. **That is the same defect that parked the previous premise, in different clothes, inside the section written to prevent it.**

The repair is not to shut a route. It is that the open route does not deliver. Yardley is reachable on day three, agrees to see Ally, and tells her the truth without being pressed. **And it is worth nothing.** A seventy-one-year-old doctor's retrospective doubt about a five-year-old certificate is not evidence, does not trigger a referral, does not stop Colin, and cannot be acted on by Del. It has only destroyed him.

★ The episode's constraint is not access. It is that the only decisive evidence is inside a living woman who will not consent to the test.

C1. What Ally can lawfully reach

Day	Item	Held by	Authority	What it gives
1	Josie's account	Josie	Hers, freely given, and she will not be recorded	A name, a street, and no evidence
1	The title history of 14 Orchard Steps	Public register	R14, permanent and public	Sixteen years on one page and the same name twice
2	Del Cruz	HCPD	She can hear all of it	Del can do nothing, and says so precisely. She names what would change that, and it is a living blood level
3	Dr Alan Yardley	Himself	He agrees to see her	★ Everything, on the first afternoon, freely. And it changes nothing
3	Winnie Aspinall	Herself	Her own door	Sharp, rich, rude, unwell, and entirely uninterested in being rescued
4	Colin Meade	Himself	Delighted to talk	Warm, open, and he shows Ally the garden
4	Josie's filed report	Highcliff Home Care	★ It exists, it is dated, and using it identifies her. Decision 1	The only document proving somebody raised this before Ally existed
5	Marion Larkin	Herself	Hers	<i>"She told me the lamps had gone green"</i>
6	Gordon's grave	Public	Public record	Buried, not cremated. Colin did not choose that
8+	Edith's records	Marion, as next of kin, R10 and R11	Marion requests them, never Ally	The two February visits, and what was not ordered

C2. Closed, and it stays closed

Item	Why
Gordon's death certificate and medical records	R11 and R10. No next of kin, and his executor is Colin
Edith's, in Ally's own hands	R10 and R11: Marion's, never Ally's. Ally is told, not shown
The Y-5 pharmacy note	The pharmacy's, R8, seven years, so it survives five more months. Police on a referral. Never Ally
Edith's pharmacy record	Gone. R8 expired nine years ago. The first death cannot be proved and never will be
Edith's remains	Cremated
Winnie's blood	★ Hers. Nobody on earth can take it without her consent, and that is the episode
Voss street cameras	Private, theirs, R7 thirty-one days. Police can flag them. Ally cannot have them

★ The retention rulings do the dramatic work. The first death unprovable forever, the second inside the window by five months, the third not yet happened and locked inside a competent adult's right to refuse a blood test.

PART D. THE ANTAGONIST'S LEAST-COST LEDGER

★ v1.0 failed here and the audit was right: a completed flat sale hands him cash and fewer ties. The trap is now evidential and it is already sprung before lead 1.

From	His cheapest action	Why
Always	Kindness, in public, for a year or two	The method, not the disguise
Three weeks ago onward	★ He has already started, so there is no clean exit. A level drawn this week shows it. Withdrawing now leaves a living witness with poisoned blood and a doctor who has already wondered twice	This is the repair to finding 1 and it does not require a debt, an obligation or anything invented
When Ally appears	Be delighted. Invite her in, answer everything, show her the garden	There is nothing in the house to find
When Ally persists	★ Tell Winnie. His weapon is an eighty-one-year-old woman's dignity, not violence	Winnie shuts every door in Havenbay herself, and means it
Cancel the carer	Already done, nine days before Day 1, and Winnie backed him up	Removing the only outside observer, which is exactly what he did twice before, expressed as a rota rather than a house move
★ If told the certification rules changed	★ Stop, and go. He is not suicidal and he is not proud. He would rather be a man who was kind to three old people	He does not know. He is running the model he learned in Year –16

PART E. THE CLOCK

★ Day 18 is deleted. The audit was right twice: R14 covers completed transfers rather than private completion dates, and moving in changed nothing he could not already do.

The clock is Winnie's own decline, and it is already running. Digoxin accumulates. There is a window in which a level proves everything and past which she dies. **The player watches her get worse across the episode.**

It is day-stamped by a human appointment, not by arithmetic: Day 12, the last scheduled care visit. After that nobody outside that house sees her. Colin arranged it nine days before Ally heard his name, and Winnie herself confirmed it.

△ **The seven-week and five-week intervals from v1.0 are struck out entirely.** They were flagged as a trap and then made load-bearing, exactly as the audit says. **Nothing now rests on them, and no draft may reintroduce them.**

PART F. SIXTEEN LEADS

Phase One, leads 1 to 6 — a house, and a woman who is already ill

#	What the player does	What changes
1	Josie's call	A woman is being killed now, somebody knows, and there is nothing on the record
2	The title history	Sixteen years on one page and the same name on it twice
3	Del, and Yardley	Del names what would change things. Yardley tells Ally everything that afternoon
4	It was worth nothing	Retrospective doubt is not evidence. Ally has burned him and gained nothing. Decision 1
5	Winnie	She is unwell, she knows she is unwell, and she will not discuss it
6	Edith and Gordon	A stenographer and a man with pigeons. Two lives, not two illnesses

Midpoint, lead 7 — the green lamps

Marion says the sentence she has carried for sixteen years without knowing what it was. **The player stops investigating a property and starts investigating a poisoning.**

★ **The merge board's best shot at the project's rank-one question.** The player has assembled public paper that individually means nothing. One sentence from a daughter re-reads all of it.

Phase Two, leads 8 to 11 — consent

#	What the player does	What changes
8	Marion has standing Ally never will	Decision 2
9	Colin	Warm, open, delighted, and he shows her the garden
10	The only proof is in Winnie	And Winnie is a competent adult who has said no
11	How to get a blood test into an arm	Decision 3
★	⚠ Somewhere in 9 to 11, Ally learns the certification rules changed three years ago. Route: Del, or Yardley, who has been living with it since it came in	Colin will be caught. After.

Phase Three, leads 12 to 16 — the last visit

#	What the player does	What changes
12	Day 12. Josie's last visit	Whatever she sees, she sees for the last time
13	The consequence of Decision 3	Either Winnie knows and has chosen him, or Yardley has done something he cannot undo
14	The referral, or the absence of one	Police work: the grave, the pharmacy note, the cameras
15	★ He does not know	Decision 4
16	The close	Somebody is alive, or somebody is answered for. Not both

PART G. THE FOUR DECISIONS

★ All four rebuilt. The audit found one demonstrated decision, two false or reversible trades and one undemonstrated. The false costs are gone.

#	Lead	Class	Choice	Rejoins
1	4	A	Use Josie's filed report, or protect her	7
2	8	B	Send Marion after her mother's records now, or hold her back	10
3	11	C	Tell Winnie everything, or let Yardley invent a reason to test her	14
4	15	A	Tell Colin the rules changed, or let Del run it	close

Arithmetic: two Class A, one Class C, rejoins of 3, 2, 3, 1, no fork opens before the current branch rejoins, leads 7, 10 and 14 shared.

Decision 1 • lead 4 • Class A

Use it. Josie's report is dated seven weeks before Ally existed. It is the difference between a podcaster's theory and a professional's recorded concern, and it is what gets Del to listen. **Protect her.** Nobody outside the agency ever knows she raised it, and Ally has nothing but her own voice.

Irreversible, and it lands on a named person: Josie's job and her registration, or the only evidence that this did not start with Ally.

Decision 2 · lead 8 · Class B

★ **v1.0's stated cost was false and the audit was right: verification does not remove Marion's standing.** The real trade:

Send her now. Marion requests Edith's records as next of kin and it moves. **A records request on Edith Larkin is one phone call from Orchard Steps, and Colin hears about it. Hold her back.** Colin gets no warning, and Marion later learns Ally knew for a week and left her ringing about a gas bill. **She is the only person who will still be fighting for Edith in a year.**

Irreversible: Colin's warning, or Marion's willingness to fight.

Decision 3 · lead 11 · Class C

★ **The moral centre, and unlike v1.0's version the two options are genuinely exclusive,** because they are two different ways of getting the same needle into the same arm and only one can happen first.

Tell Winnie everything. She is a competent adult and she is entitled to the truth about her own life. She will not believe it, she will tell Colin, and she will be right that she was not consulted about any of it until it was convenient. **Let Yardley call her in.** He invents a routine review, does not say why, and draws the blood. **It is the second time he has put his name to something he should not, and this time he does it knowing.** It ends him.

Irreversible: Winnie's autonomy and any chance Ally had with her, or Yardley's registration and the last three years of his life.

Decision 4 · lead 15 · Class A

★ **Unique to this premise, and it exists only because of the Part J1 ruling.**

Tell Colin the rules changed. He stops. He goes. **Winnie lives.** Edith and Gordon are closed forever, Marion never gets an answer, and Josie lost her job for nothing. **Let Del run it.** The test, the grave, the pharmacy note and the cameras make a case that answers for all three. **It is slower, and Winnie is in that house while it happens.**

Neither is obviously right. One is certainty for the living woman at the price of the dead. The other is a chance at all three at the price of the only one who can still be saved.

Irreversible: two deaths never answered for, or the days Winnie spends inside it.

Counterfactual

Remove every decision: Colin is not warned, Winnie dies in about five weeks, the independent reviewer catches him afterwards, Marion learns what the green lamps were from a court report, and Josie keeps her job. **Named people's outcomes change on every branch, in both directions, and the counterfactual is not the worst outcome on every axis.**

PART H. THE THIRTEEN-OBJECTION PRE-FLIGHT

- 1. Why not found at the time?** Nothing cross-references a death against a property or a beneficiary, and **the one person who should have caught it is named as having failed, with a reason.** Part B.
 - 2. Antagonist in his own interest?** Yes, and Part D now survives the day Ally knocks: he cannot exit cleanly because he has already started.
 - 3. Would a real person do the small thing?** A stenographer describes her own symptom precisely. A pharmacist records a plausible reason and supplies. A provider files a staff concern and tells the staff member not to discuss it. A woman of eighty-one refuses to be fussed over.
 - 4. Motive an ordinary reader accepts?** Houses.
 - 5. A coincidence wearing a coat?** △ One, answered rather than removed: Josie attended both Gordon and Winnie, because three agencies serve that district and have for thirty years. **First thing to give up if step 3 pushes again.**
 - 6. Every word understood?** △ Not in this document. See Part I for what the opening may not say.
 - 7. Cast held on one pass?** △ **Eight named people. Part I caps the opening at four.**
 - 8. Clear what the crime is?** A man is kind to old people until they leave him the house, and he is doing it right now to a woman who is alive.
 - 9. Can Ally source it?** Every fact traces to a public register, a person who chose to speak, or something the police did and told her. **Nothing reaches her through a power she does not have.**
 - 10. Breaks its own rules?** Not found. **Josie's refusal to be recorded is the recording law used deliberately, and it now has a cause: she has already been told once not to discuss it.**
 - 11. ★ Claims a route is the only one? ★ No, and this time it is demonstrated rather than asserted.** Yardley is open, speaks freely on day three, and delivers nothing. **The constraint is consent, not access.**
 - 12. Stake?** A living woman being poisoned now, two unprovable deaths, a daughter's sixteen years, a doctor's whole life.
 - 13. Anything decisive on a small number? ★ The intervals are struck out.** The reversal is a sentence from a daughter and a blood test on a living woman. **No draft may reintroduce a countdown made of weeks.**
- Person or mechanism?** A person, in a room with the player at lead 4, whose weapon is charm and whose second weapon is his victim's own dignity.
-

PART I. WHAT THE PRE-FLIGHT CAUGHT

- 1. Objection 7. Eight named people.** Ally, Del, Colin, Yardley, Winnie, Marion, Josie, plus two dead. **Opening cap: four.** Ally, Winnie, Colin, and one of Josie or Yardley.
- 2. Objection 6. Banned from the opening:** digoxin · toxicity · therapeutic window · blood level · certification · coroner · referral · medical examiner · probate · executor · next of kin · safeguarding ·

registration. **Permitted:** *her heart pills · the house · the will · the doctor · the garden · her shopping · the last visit is on the twelfth · the lamps had gone green.*

3. ★ Carried from the audit's representation note, and it is a craft instruction not a caveat.

Edith and Gordon still need lives more specific than illnesses, wills and houses. Fixed in the spine — a stenographer who could read a conversation back word for word, and a man who gave up his pigeons because of a ladder. **Both are load-bearing as well as human**, which is the only kind of detail that survives.

4. Objection 5. Josie attending both Gordon and Winnie remains the one coincidence.

5. The opening still has no body, and the audit's determination is accepted: that is an asset. **The reader check must still ask it directly.**

PART J. RULINGS AND QUESTIONS

Ruled by Stephen, 2026-08-27, during this rework

J1. ★ Havenbay introduced independent review of every non-coronial death certificate three years ago. A medical examiner checks the stated cause and may contact a representative. *Effect:* Edith and Gordon both predate it and were closed correctly by Yardley alone. **Winnie's death would be caught.** Colin does not know, because he learned how the world works in Year -16. **This ruling produced Decision 4 and it is the best decision in the episode.** It also states the thing the episode is actually about: being caught afterwards is not the same as being stopped.

J2. ★ A pharmacist queried Colin's early repeat and resolved it correctly. He gave an ordinary true-sounding reason, she recorded it and supplied. *Effect:* nobody is incompetent, the Y-5 dispensing note survives inside R8's seven years as real corroboration, and it is the third complete accurate record nobody read.

J3. ★ Ruth Yardley was not a victim, and Yardley suspected she was. For about a week, nine years ago, he looked, and he was wrong. *Effect:* his blindness to Edith and Gordon has a cause, and the cause is decency turned inside out. **One short scene. Nothing dangles.**

Still open

#	Question	What turns on it
4	What safeguarding duty does a Havenbay home-care worker and provider have on suspicion of medication abuse or lethal risk, and what happens to a filed concern?	Lead 1 and Decision 1. Recommended: the duty exists, Josie discharged it in writing, the provider recorded it, told her not to discuss it and did nothing
5	Can a body be exhumed, on whose authority and on what evidence?	Leads 14 to 16, and whether Gordon is provable at all
6	Who may formally identify the certifying doctor on a restricted certificate, before any referral exists?	Probably needs no ruling: Ally gets Yardley's name from Marion, who is Edith's next of kin, and from Winnie, whose GP he is. Recorded so step 3 can check the workaround
7	Does a competently made will survive its beneficiary being convicted of the death?	The last line only

Struck: the v1.0 question about R14 exposing pending completion dates. **The audit was right that it does not, and the clock that needed it is gone.**

PART K. RISKS RECORDED

- 1. ✓ Representation.** Accepted from the audit in full: this genuinely moves the set, by changing the victims' ages, including a male victim, replacing intimate-partner violence with trusted-caregiver predation, and making **autonomy rather than disappearance** the contested value. **△ It becomes a comfortable substitution the moment "elderly" is shorthand for isolated, credulous and disposable.** Winnie's refusal resists that structurally; Edith and Gordon now have lives. **The written episode has to prove it sees old people rather than a new class of convenient victims, and that is a prose test, not a spine test.**
- 2. Winnie has to be genuinely good.** Sharp, rich, rude, ill, and right that she is being patronised. **★ She is now mechanically load-bearing as well as thematically: the decisive evidence is inside her and she can refuse.** If she is written as a victim waiting, the episode is dead.
- 3. No body at the top.** Asset, per the audit, and still untested. **Point the reader check straight at it.**
- 4. Havenbay necessity, thin in the honest way.** Highcliff sells privacy as a service, and that is real and it is not the whole claim. Relocate to another wealthy district in another city and much of it survives. Recorded, not dressed up.
- 5. Yardley is carrying a lot** — the two certificates, the clinical act, and the Ruth week. **Watch for overload in the prose.**

6. Still unrun: the evidence-turn test. Lead 7 is where this premise would demonstrate it.

PART L. PRODUCTION ENVELOPE

- Sixteen leads, three phases, four decisions, one Class C.
 - **Existing cast:** Ally, Del. **New portraits:** Colin, Winnie, Yardley. Josie and Marion voice-only or single-pose.
 - **Locations:** the studio, one Highcliff terrace exterior and interior, a garden, a surgery, a cemetery. ⚠ **Highcliff is canon and has never been built. Price it before commitment.**
 - **No body is shown and no death is staged.** The mechanism is described twice and never depicted. **Winnie's deterioration is played, and it is the only physical consequence on screen.**
 - **Code, verified 2026-08-27:** ✅ lead counter fixed, sixteen leads display correctly · ✅
`requiresFlag / forbidsFlag` supports the branches · ⚠ `CaseResolutionService.cs:12` hardcodes `EpisodeId = "e1_the_listener"`, and a separate session is auditing the multi-episode bill.
-

NEXT

Step 3, second pass: ChatGPT attacks v1.1. Point it at Part D first (does he still have a cheap exit), then Part G Decision 3 (are the two routes genuinely exclusive), then Part Co.

Step 4: Fable writes one opening. Four names, the banned list, Winnie written as a person who does not want saving, and Edith and Gordon given lives.

Step 5: two questions, plus one asked explicitly: does a murder that has not happened yet pull as hard as a body.